Introduction

Have you ever taken leave from the school due to sickness? What happens exactly when we become sick? Sometimes, we feel good even without taking any medicines and sometimes we need to consult a doctor and take regular medicines to be healed. Why is it so?

To prevent and treat sickness successfully, it is necessary to have complete understanding of the common sicknesses in the area and the combination of things that caused them. This lesson may help you to understand the various causes of sickness. In this lesson we are going to study about health and hygiene, care of the body, dieseases, health problems of children and safety.

6.1 Hygiene

Health is the best wealth. If you have good health, you will have a sound mind and you will gain good knowledge and wealth also. Health refers to a state of a sound mind and body free from any sickness or ailment, stress and problems. In simple words, health refers to the physical, emotional and psychological well-being of a person. To maintain good health, you should follow good hygiene, eat nutritious food, do exercise, take rest and have a sound sleep.

Hygiene refers to the good habits and their practices which are followed to prevent diseases, maintain good health, especially through cleanliness, consumption of safe drinking water and proper disposal of sewage. It refers to all those activities that are done for improving and maintaining good health and sound mind.

Maintenance of personal and environmental hygiene is called cleanliness. In simple words, it refers to the state of being clean which is essential for good health. To protect us from diseases it is essential to maintain good health by taking regular bath, cleaning the clothes and surroundings and also avoiding unhygienic food consumption.

6.1.1 Personal hygiene

Personal hygiene is defined as the branch of health which is concerned with the individual's adjustment to the physiological needs of the body and mind for the attainment of the maximum level of health. It also refers to the cleaning and grooming of the body.



Cold and flu are some of the common communicable diseases. They are caused not only by bacteria but also by virus. When you have cold and flu, you may also have running nose, cough, sore throat, and sometimes fever or pain in the joints. For some, this condition may also lead to mild diarrhoea.

What will happen, if cold affected friend/ classmate of you, sneezes or cough in front of you? When he sneezes some secretions may come out of his nose. Secretions oozing out